

Sarah Jade Pratt

Dual American and Canadian citizen

 sarahjade.ca

 sjp23@sfu.ca

 [sarah-jade-pratt](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sarah-jade-pratt)

Summary

Ambitious and detail-oriented computer science graduate student with a focus on human-computer interaction, coming from a strong background in software development at all stages of the lifecycle development process.

My current research focuses on investigating novel user interactions with emerging technologies, including human-AI and human-robot interaction, underscoring my dedication to aligning innovation with user needs.

Technical Experience

- Software development
- Web design and development
- User research methods: usability studies, needfinding, design space analysis
- Project management

Technical Skills

- Python, C#, Java, SQL
- PowerBI
- JIRA
- Agile and waterfall
- Statistics
- Figma

Education

Master of Science in Computing Science,
Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, Canada
09/24 – expected 06/26

- Guaranteed funding thesis-based program
- NSERC CGS M Candidate

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science,
University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
Minor in Applied Music Technology
09/16 – 06/20

- Class 1 standing
- Dean's List
- Chancellor's Scholar Award
- Outstanding International Student Award

Experience

Graduate Research Assistant

Simon Fraser University, Burnaby, Canada
09/24 – Present

- **Design space analysis:** Undertaking extensive and systematic literature review to determine design guidelines and best practices for novel interactions with directional sound.
- **Needfinding and usability:** To determine user interaction design elements for a proposed novel user interaction technique, I conducted a 25 participant needfinding survey and interview for an ongoing project. We then conduct a usability study to evaluate prototype design.
- **Scientific outreach:** Presentation at poster session to describe the results of human-robot interaction study that investigates cognitive and emotional of robot design qualities

Teaching Assistant

Simon Fraser University, Burnaby, Canada
09/24 – Present

- **Technical communication:** Supporting a 185-student introductory course designed to teach Python. Provide in-lecture assistance, hold office hours to address questions on foundational computing science topics, like recursion, basic algorithms, and Python programming and environment questions.
- **Process improvement:** Developing custom scripts to automate parts of the grading process of various assignments and exams to improve efficiency and feedback consistency.

Software Developer

RedMane Technology, Burnaby, Canada

02/21 – 11/23

- **Technical leadership:** Developed and documented new team processes to reduce onboarding friction and remove development blockages. Embraced a leadership role to train and mentor new hires as one of the youngest senior developers. Maintained code and test quality standards, reinforced with detail-oriented code reviews. Maintained excellent cross-functional team relationships to ensure alignment with custom needs.
- **Strategic planning:** Drove the increase of client adoption of health care benefit and child welfare management software across Canada and the US, helping the company scale rapidly. Delivered sales demos, consistently met tight deadlines for several concurrent projects. Worked with external vendors and cross-functional teams to integrate external services within the native platform.
- **Customer advocate:** Led the customer success team as the lead developer, handling high-priority clients with responsiveness and expertise. Used Datadog to monitor performance of cloud-scale applications. Used PowerBI to visualize system analytics, and proactively identify performance or user issues.

Acoustic Software Developer Intern

Blackberry QNX, Burnaby, Canada

05/19 – 12/19

- **Research and development:** Created a set of interactive test frameworks in Python, including synthetic data generation, to use for the development of voice-enhancement audio algorithms in embedded software systems, integrated with cloud-based speech recognition and word detection APIs.
- **Data visualization:** Created custom data visualizations to inform business and technical decisions.

Volunteer

Graduate Mentor

SFU Women in Computing Science, Vancouver, Canada

09/24 – Present

- **Leadership:** Provide guidance to female graduate students, helping them navigate their academic and career paths in computer science via one-on-one meetings to discuss academic strategies and give career advice, with the goal to empower mentees to thrive and act confidently.

Wayfinding Volunteer

Vancouver General Hospital, Vancouver, Canada

09/22 – Present

- **Empathic communication:** Assisted patients and visitors in the navigation and understanding of British Columbia's largest hospital, functional areas, and processes. Overcame language and cultural barriers during chaotic and urgent circumstances to provide exceptional patient and visitor experiences.

Personal Interests

- **Goal-oriented:** Triathlons, marathons, ultramarathons, long distance trail running, hot yoga
- **Creative:** Ambient techno music production
- **Organized:** Creating highly structured and curated social events